PassFrame
TUITION

The Otter's Secret Pool

Year 4 — 11+ Homework Worksheet (PassFrame Tuition)

Comprehension | Fiction

Extract — read it carefully before answering

Every morning, before the village had even rubbed the sleep from its eyes, Pip the otter slipped out of her burrow and down to the secret pool. The water there was so still that it looked like a sheet of green glass, and the willow trees leaned over it as if they were whispering secrets to one another.

Pip loved the pool because nobody else knew about it — not the ducks who quacked loudly by the millpond, not the herons who stood like grey statues at the river's edge, and certainly not Old Badger, who grumbled about everything.

One cold morning, Pip found something strange floating on the water: a little paper boat, folded so carefully that it must have taken someone hours to make. She nudged it gently with her nose, and it spun in a slow circle, as graceful as a dancer.

'Who could have made this?' Pip wondered. She searched the muddy bank for footprints but found none — only a single white feather resting on a stone.

Pip decided to leave the little boat exactly where she had found it. Whoever had made it might come back, and she wanted them to know that the secret pool kept its visitors' secrets too.

That evening, as the sun sank behind the hills, Pip noticed the paper boat had gone. In its place lay a tiny acorn, polished until it shone like gold.

Questions

25 min · 12 questions

1. What time of day did Pip usually visit the pool?

2. Which animals does the text say did NOT know about the secret pool?

3. Underline the sentence that tells you the paper boat had been made with great care.

4. Underline 2 examples of personification in the extract.

5. What does “graceful” mean as it is used to describe the paper boat spinning?

6. Put these events in the order they happened: Pip finds an acorn / Pip finds a paper boat / Pip searches for footprints / the paper boat disappears.

7. Why might the author have chosen a pool that “nobody else knew about” for this story?

8. What object did Pip find resting on a stone?

9. How do you think Pip felt when she discovered the paper boat had vanished?

10. What does the shining acorn suggest about who left it?

11. Why might describing the herons as standing “like grey statues” help the reader picture them?

12. Write one sentence predicting what might happen the next time Pip visits the pool.